Sam Finard

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SUMMARY

Financial associate with 2+ years shipping Python automation, data pipelines, and reconciliation tooling for a fixed-income trading desk. Owns systems end-to-end — nightly jobs, alerting, monitoring.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python, VBA, familiarity with SQL
- **Platforms & Tools:** Beacon, Bloomberg Terminal, Git, Jira, Excel
- **Domains:** Fixed income, Risk/PnL attribution, trade reconciliation, workflow automation

EXPERIENCE

SMBC — Associate, Fixed Income December 2023 – Present

- Built end-to-end workflow automation: email-to-database pipelines, Microsoft Teams alerting bots, and nightly job monitoring — replacing legacy processes that required manual intervention.
- Built a Python comparison script to reconcile cashflows across systems, surfacing breaks for trader review; partnered with quant developers on logic and integration.
- Developed a visualization tool displaying interest rate curve with T-1, T+0, and T+1 pricing dates using internal Rates databases and live rate feeds from Refinitiv.
- Partner with traders to triage high-stakes Risk/PnL issues under tight end-of-day deadline
- Drove team-wide accountability and real-time progress visibility by introducing Jira project tracking and daily synchronization meetings

Octavate — Software Engineering Intern October 2023 – December 2023

- Developed Python pipelines (SQL, DBeaver) to surface emerging artists from streaming and social data, and applied MTCNN CNNs to extract artist facial embeddings from imagery.

NYU AI & Predictive Analytics Lab — Undergraduate Researcher October 2023 – May 2024

- Researched creativity in LLMs under Professor Anasse Bari; built a corpus of prior work and developed an evaluation model comparing generative capacity across existing LLMs.

USAMTS — Contest Grader October 2023 – November 2024

- Graded student submissions in a national high-school math olympiad; wrote individualized feedback on proof methodology and structure.

PROJECTS

Predicting Dow Jones Index Movements with Billboard Hot 100 Sentiment Analysis August 2023

- Built end-to-end NLP pipeline ingesting 3,100+ Billboard Hot 100 songs; engineered sentiment features using Python NLP libraries and trained regression models in RapidMiner to predict DJIA closes, identifying a statistically significant correlation.

EDUCATION

New York University — B.A. in Computer Science December 2024

- Minors in Mathematics and Music
- Coursework: Algorithms, Data Structures, Predictive Analytics.
- Treasurer, SLAM! Poetry — recognized as a top NYU club leader (2021–2023).